

4.4 Conditional Operators

We've seen how conditional operators work, in chapter 3. These include the *if...else* statement, which we've used in the example above. Then there is the *if...elseif* statement, which isn't as efficient as the *switch* statement when multiple conditions are possible. The *switch* statement is perfect for use when multiple conditions are present, and looks much more streamlined than the blockier coding that would result if the *elseif* statement were to be used.

Then there are the *for* and *while* loops, the syntaxes of which are as follows:

```
for (initialization; condition; increment)
{
    code to be executed;
}

and

while (condition)
    code to be executed;
```

There is also the *do-while* statement, which causes execution of a block of code at least once, and is then based on the fulfilment of the condition stated in the *while* statement.

Let's move on to our next example, since it's much easier to follow programming syntax, with a practical hands-on! PHP has a number of conditional operators, and the *for*, *while*, *switch*, and *if* statements can be used. The *for* and *while* loops have been used in the example below.